

## Ἀδήσποτα Λυρικά

# Lyric Fragments from Anonymous Greek Poets

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**Period:** *Κλασική* [Classical](#)  
**Dialect:** *Μικτὰὶ διάλεκτοι* [Mixed Dialects](#)  
**Domain:** *Ποίησις* [Poetry](#)  
**Format:** *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Lyric Poets Anonymous is a collective designation for the unnamed authors of early Greek lyric poetry, composed from the 8th to the 4th century BCE. These poets originated from regions across the Greek world, including Ionia, Aeolia, and the Dorian Peloponnese. They operated as skilled artisans within civic and ritual frameworks, creating verse intended for musical performance at symposia, religious festivals, and public ceremonies.

The surviving corpus consists of fragmentary pieces preserved through later quotations, papyrus scraps, and inscriptions. These fragments represent various sub-genres such as skolia, or drinking songs, partheneia, or maiden songs, hymns, and threnoi, or laments. Scholars designate this body of work as the *Lyrica Adespota*, which includes examples like the "Linos-song" fragment.

These anonymous fragments are crucial for understanding the breadth and social function of early Greek poetry beyond major named figures. They provide direct evidence for popular, ritual, and symposiastic culture, revealing widespread themes of love, death, celebration, and myth. The mixed dialects within the corpus reflect the panhellenic diffusion of poetic forms and their local origins.

## Works (1)

- [Λυρικά Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Lyric Fragments](#) · 217 passages